

VERSION 1.0 - PRODUCTION CANDIDATE

French Workbook

Français

Writing and pronunciation foundations, core grammar, 1,000 audited vocabulary entries, and 1,000 curated bilingual practice sentences with handwriting and retrieval space.

Foundations

Natural, idiomatic learner language takes priority over artificial uniqueness. Genuine homographs are retained when their learner meaning and grammatical role differ. A source-backed pronunciation key is taught in Foundations; sentence drills then use normal target-language spelling rather than inconsistent ad-hoc romanization.

Foundations

Target register: contemporary standard French. These pages orient deliberate practice; the vocabulary and sentence sections provide the bulk of retrieval work.

Script / alphabet reference

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Use this as a compact reference, then practice connected words rather than isolated shapes alone.

Numbers 0-10

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

**zéro · un · deux · trois · quatre · cinq · six · sept · huit
· neuf · dix**

Articles and gender

French nouns have grammatical gender. Learn a noun with its article whenever practical because article and adjective forms depend on gender and number.

Agreement

Many adjectives and past participles change form according to gender and number. Do not infer pronunciation changes from spelling changes automatically.

Verb system

High-frequency verbs are often irregular. Learn common present forms early, then build passé composé, imperfect, future, and conditional patterns around real sentences.

Negation

Standard written French commonly uses *ne ... pas* around a finite verb. In informal speech, *ne* is often omitted, but the workbook keeps standard forms unless a source sentence naturally reflects conversational usage.

Questions

Questions can use intonation, *est-ce que*, or inversion. Register and context determine which sounds most natural.

Pronouns

Object pronouns normally appear before the finite verb. Their order is fixed, so learn common combinations as chunks rather than translating word by word.

Handwriting warm-up

Copy five useful words from today's lesson, then write them again from memory.

Pronunciation quick-start

Broad contemporary standard/Metropolitan French reference pronunciation. The guide highlights contrasts that commonly cause beginner errors and explicitly marks features that vary by region, register, or speech rate.

Notation: slashes // show broad IPA phonemes or practical reference targets. They are more precise than English respellings but still do not encode every accent or connected-speech detail.

u versus ou

u /y/ · ou /u/

Keep these vowels distinct. For /y/, hold the tongue near the position for /i/ while rounding the lips; /u/ is a back rounded vowel.

Nasal vowels

sans /sɑ̃/ · son /sɔ̃/ · pain /pɛ̃/ · un /œ̃/

These are broad reference examples. Many speakers merge /œ̃/ with /ɛ̃/, and spelling-to-sound patterns have lexical exceptions, so do not generalize from letters alone.

French r

r /ʀ/

A common standard reference target is uvular. Its exact phonetic realization can range from approximant-like to fricative or trill-like across speakers and contexts.

Schwa

e /ə/ in some contexts

Schwa may be pronounced or omitted depending on the word, rhythm, register, and surrounding sounds. Not every written e represents /ə/.

Word-final consonants

often silent, but lexical

Many final consonant letters are not pronounced, but there are important word-specific exceptions. Learn the pronunciation with the lexical item instead of applying a blanket deletion rule.

Liaison

latent final consonant + following vowel sound

In appropriate grammatical contexts a normally silent final consonant can surface before a following vowel sound. Liaison can be obligatory, optional, or forbidden; it is not triggered mechanically before every vowel-initial word.

Elision

j'aime · l'ami

Certain short function words lose a final vowel before a following vowel sound or mute h, and the apostrophe marks the elision in writing.

Rhythm

phrase/rhythm-group prominence

French does not use English-style fixed lexical stress on each content word. Prominence tends to fall near the end of a rhythm group, with phrasing and speech style affecting the result.

Three-step pronunciation routine

1. Mark /y/ versus /u/, nasal vowels, and any liaison or elision before reading a phrase aloud.
2. Read in short rhythm groups rather than stressing each content word as though it were English.
3. Use the IPA as a broad target and confirm unfamiliar lexical exceptions rather than inventing pronunciations from spelling alone.

Sentence drills intentionally stay in normal target-language spelling: the pronunciation key supports decoding without creating dependence on ad-hoc romanization.

Sources, licensing, and QA scope

Vocabulary: drawn from this repository's canonical audited top-1,000 deck for the language. Repository source and audit records remain the source of truth.

Arabic and French sentences: quality-filtered from the ManyThings bilingual exports of the Tatoeba Project, with supplied sentence-level attribution retained under CC BY 2.0 France.

Urdu sentences: original controlled standard-Urdu learner sentences authored for this workbook from reviewed grammar-safe conversation families. They replace a rejected external candidate corpus that failed the release linguistic audit.

Quality scope: release gates check canonical dataset integrity, row counts, duplicate handling, script plausibility, sentence-type balance, source diversity where applicable, blocked Urdu legacy-error patterns, PDF structure, font embedding, and renderability. These checks materially reduce risk but do not substitute for independent native-speaker editorial certification; no absolute error-free claim is made.

Pronunciation foundations: broad-IPA and articulatory guidance was cross-checked against Karin C. Ryding, *A Reference Grammar of Modern Standard Arabic* (Cambridge University Press); Bernard Tranel, *The Sounds of French: An Introduction* (Cambridge University Press); Saleem et al., *Urdu Consonantal and Vocalic Sounds* (CRULP / Center for Language Engineering); and the Omniglot Urdu-script reference for Nastaliq, nūn ghunnah, and aspirated-letter conventions. These are broad learner reference targets, not a claim that each language has one accent-free phonetic realization.